

Element B: Documentation and Analysis of Prior Design Attempts

Sandiyah M.

Prior Design Attempt #1 (Paper Windows)



Details/Analysis:

The first three attempts at a fake window were all essentially just drawings. The first two were drawings printed onto poster paper and the last one was a drawing on cardboard. Naturally this was unsuccessful because these designs lacked one of the major features of an actual window- the ability to emit light. In addition, they didn't stand out from the other posters in the room very much which means that they also couldn't provide students with visual contrast from the classroom. Our design requirements were that the design be attractive, stand out from the rest of the room, and be durable. These designs don't fit two out of the three requirements. Not only do they not stand out but they're also not very durable as they're made from cheap materials.

An Le

Prior Design Attempt #2 (Light Box)

Source: <https://iliketomakestuff.com/would-this-fake-window-fool-you/>

Image:



Image Credits: [I Like To Make Stuff](https://iliketomakestuff.com/would-this-fake-window-fool-you/)

Details/Analysis:

I Like To Make Stuff is a website where DIYers come together for inspiration for at-home projects. One of the projects provided is “Would This Fake Window Fool You?”, which includes instructions to create an artificial window. This design can be seen in the images above. In this design, the artificial window is composed of hardwood, light panels, and a Bluetooth switch with a dimmer. In these instructions, there are links to the materials used in this design. The list of materials shown proves that this design is very costly and unapproachable for teachers. For example, one of the materials listed in this design is a Leviton Bluetooth Switch with Dimmer, the cost of this material is currently \$73.02 on Amazon. The price alone makes the design unrealistic for teachers and schools to implement it in classrooms. Aside from the cost of the materials, the nature of this design is also impractical. For this design, it’s necessary to cut out the wall to install the window, which can be seen in the images provided. Cutting holes into the walls of classrooms is an unappealing idea to schools and it limits a teacher’s ability to organize their room at will because the window is stuck in a fixed place. Lastly, it’s important to note that this design lacks scenery. This can also be seen in the provided picture, the main goal of this design was to provide a sense of natural lighting, however, it fails to create an engaging environment. To many this design may appear no different to the ceiling lights. Overall, the design provided by *I Like To Make Stuff* is too expensive, inflexible, and unengaging for a classroom setting.

Marilyn Phan

Prior Design Attempt #3 (LED Skylight)

Source: <https://www.bbier.com/what-is-led-skylight-2.html>

Image:



Image Credits: [MyPlanetLED](#), [ArtificialSky](#), [ProskyPanels](#)

Details/Analysis:

The image shown above is composed of a piece of paper with a realistic photo of clouds pasted on top of ceiling lights. It is an attempt to create a fake skylight inside buildings. The light from the ceiling light shines through the paper and gives the illusion of a brighter image and panel. This design was unsuccessful at solving the problem because it's only practical when the ceiling light is turned on. However, some people have their ceiling lights off and prefer to use lamps instead. This could be a problem since these artificial indoor skylights require ceiling light in order to illuminate. As a result, this design was not user friendly as it consisted of limited functions and conceptions.

Vivian Nguyen

Prior Design Attempt #4 (Wall Decal)

NoAmazon.com: WRIGAEL Fake Window for Walls Faux Window Decal Windows Poster Picture Open Window Wall Art Decor, Stick and Peel Wallpaper Nature Wall Decol Palms Beach Scene Mural, 32"x48" : Tools & Home Improvement. (n.d.). Wwww.amazon.com. Retrieved February 27, 2024, from

Source: <https://www.amazon.com/WRIGAEL-Fake-Windows-Picture-Wallpaper/dp/B0CP194H6D>



Details/Analysis:

This is a decal that can be pasted onto any flat wall. Single use with a matte finish. A good alternative if you want some nature in your room, however cannot be seen when the lights are turned off. It's also single use and an adhesive, which can be hard to remove when you need to move the decal and might have some problems with the magnetic wall. It's very wasteful and looks flat, not giving the impression that there is a window in the room. Therefore, the decal is not an adequate solution for the problem, being too simple and flat to appease the stakeholders and their want for a window in their classroom.